Scenario	P50	ns/cell	Path
paint-rgb-fixed	143 µs	11.2 ns	setRGB → packCell direct (bytes in, bytes out)
paint-ascii	231 µs	18.1 ns	set({char}) → encodeCellIntoBuf (no colors, but all branches still evaluated)
paint-set-hex-palette	625 µs	49.0 ns	Paint path illustrated after this table